

# Classic Beef Burger (Variation 9)

Tags: *beef, burger, dinner, american, quick* | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 15 min | Serves: 10

## Ingredients

- 1750 g ground beef (80/20 fat ratio)
- 2.5 tsp fine salt
- 2.5/2 tsp black pepper
- 2.5/2 tsp garlic powder
- 10 brioche burger buns
- 10 slices mature cheddar
- Toppings: lettuce, tomato, red onion, pickles
- Burger sauce: 7.5 tbsp mayonnaise, 1 tbsp ketchup, 1 tbsp yellow mustard, 1 tbsp diced pickles, dash hot sauce

## Method

1. Divide beef into 4 equal portions (about 175 g each). Shape gently into patties slightly wider than the bun (they shrink when cooked).
2. Make a dimple in the centre with your thumb to prevent doming.
3. Season generously on both sides with salt, pepper, and garlic powder.
4. Mix burger sauce ingredients. Refrigerate.
5. Heat a cast-iron skillet or grill to very high heat. Brush with a little oil.
6. Cook burgers for 3–4 minutes without pressing or moving. Flip once.
7. Place cheese on the patty and cook for a further 2–3 minutes for medium (slightly pink centre).
8. Toast bun cut sides on the skillet for 1 minute.
9. Assemble: sauce on both bun halves, then lettuce, patty, tomato, onion, and pickles.

## Chef Tips

- Do not overwork the meat when forming patties — it makes them dense and tough.
- The dimple prevents the burger from puffing up into a ball during cooking.
- High heat and no pressing gives the Maillard crust that defines a great burger.